

Subscription Pricing — Market Analysis & Proposal

BIRTHRIGHT FOUNDATION · SECURE BONDS > THRIVE · EXPORTED MAY 23, 2026 17:09 UTC

Mission alignment. Birthright is a not-for-profit; subscription pricing must capture value where partners benefit financially while remaining genuinely accessible — and never charge those who help us (community referrers, researchers building eminence). This proposal threads that needle with a **traffic-adjusted multiplier** that grows with proof of value, free tiers for non-revenue partners, and an explicit **eminence-sharing** mechanism for academic contributors.

1 · Honest baseline assumption

Birthright is **pre-traction**: limited organic search visibility, no paid acquisition, public launch just completed. Charging marketplace-grade rates today would be dishonest. Every recommendation below is anchored to a **Birthright Traffic Index (BTI)** that rises only when we prove value.

2 · Market benchmarks per partner class

Facilitator class (instructor / creator)

PLATFORM	SUBSCRIPTION	TAKE RATE ON COURSES	NOTES
Teachable	\$39–\$199/mo	5–10% transaction	Industry leader
Thinkific	\$0–\$199/mo	0% at higher tiers	Self-serve
Kajabi	\$149–\$399/mo	0%	High-end
Mighty Networks	\$41–\$179/mo	2–5%	Community-focused
Coursera Plus partners	Rev-share only	40–60% to platform	Marketplace
Birthright (current seed)	\$99/mo – \$1,799 (2 yr)	30–50% to platform	High side

Verdict: Subscription price in range; on-site take rate priced like a marketplace without marketplace traffic. Keep subscription; lower facilitator take pre-traction; let BTI surge it as traffic proves out.

Vendor class

PLATFORM	SUBSCRIPTION	TAKE RATE	NOTES
Etsy	Free + \$0.20/listing	6.5% + payment fees	Massive traffic
Shopify	\$39–\$399/mo	0%	Self-hosted

PLATFORM	SUBSCRIPTION	TAKE RATE	NOTES
Amazon Handmade	\$39.99/mo	15% referral	Curated marketplace
Faire (wholesale)	Free	15–25% commission	Curated, lower traffic
Birthright (current seed)	\$49/mo – \$899 (2 yr)	18–25% to platform	Fair for curated, low traffic

Verdict: Vendor subscription is competitive vs Faire-style curated peers. Take rate at the high end of acceptable today — BTI will moderate as traffic grows.

Community / Affiliate class

PLATFORM	SUBSCRIPTION	REFERRAL %	NOTES
Amazon Associates	Free	1–10%	Massive scale
ShareASale	Free (merchants pay)	5–20%	Affiliate network
Impact.com	Free	10–30%	Higher-touch
Substack referral	Free	30% (first year)	Lifetime tier exists
Birthright (current seed)	\$29/mo – \$549 (2 yr)	8–12% to community	Subscription is uncommon

Verdict: Charging affiliates a subscription contradicts industry norms — they bring you customers and should not be billed for that. **Recommendation:** free entry tier + paid upgrade tiers with extra benefits.

Research class

PLATFORM	SUBSCRIPTION	MODEL
ResearchGate	Free	Ad / recruitment
Academia.edu	\$99/yr Premium	Reader analytics, citation alerts
SSRN	Free	Endowment-funded
Substack (academic)	Free	10% on paid subscribers
Birthright (current seed)	\$49/mo – \$899 (2 yr)	0% rev share — too high for value delivered today

Verdict: Academic platforms are mostly free; researchers benefit primarily through reputation, not revenue. **Recommendation:** free baseline + paid à-la-carte promotion + an explicit Eminence-Sharing Agreement.

3 · Eminence Sharing — formalizing non-monetary value

Research partners build their reputation through publication. The foundation's credibility lifts each time a respected researcher publishes through us. Some practical ways to share that non-monetary value:

MECHANISM	FOUNDATION GETS	RESEARCHER GETS
Co-citation requirement	Cited as platform / publisher in published work	Discoverability in academic search
Press release co-rights	Right to press-release findings with attribution	Mainstream visibility beyond academia
Speaking-engagement first-right	Right of first invitation for keynotes / workshops	Paid speaking gigs via foundation
Endorsement clause	Public endorsement on LinkedIn / ORCID / university bio	Credibility lift visible on profile
Funding-introduction commission	2–3% of any grant resulting from a foundation-initiated intro	Warm intros to funders
Data co-ownership	Foundation half-owns anonymized workshop datasets	Research access to the joint dataset

Proposal: Approved research partners sign an **Eminence Sharing Agreement** as an addendum to the v1.6.0 indemnification flow. **No subscription required.** Paid promotion (Featured / Highlighted) remains optional.

4 · Traffic-Adjusted Pricing — the Birthright Traffic Index (BTI)

A transparent multiplier that adjusts all subscription fees and take rates as the platform's true value to partners grows or shrinks.

Formula. $BTI = (\text{rolling_90d_unique_visitors} / 50,000) \times (\text{rolling_90d_conversion} / 0.025)$

- 50,000 visitors / 90 days = threshold where Etsy/Faire-equivalent rates become defensible
- 2.5% conversion = standard e-commerce baseline
- BTI = 1.0 means "comparable to competitors"; below = discount, above = premium

BTI RANGE	MULTIPLIER	PLAIN ENGLISH
0.0 – 0.2	× 0.50	Pre-traction discount — half price
0.2 – 0.5	× 0.70	Early launch tier
0.5 – 1.0	× 0.85	Approaching parity
1.0 – 1.5	× 1.00	Standard market rate
1.5 – 2.5	× 1.15	Premium — outperforming competitors
2.5+	× 1.30	Hard cap on surge

- **Recalculated** on the first of each quarter
- Existing subscribers **grandfathered** at signup rate until renewal
- Founding partners are **immune to surge increases**, but still enjoy surge decreases
- Published transparently at </governance/revenue-sharing>
- Per-partner admin overrides allowed (governance audit-logged)

5 • Recommended subscription matrix — pre-traction (BTI × 0.5)

Pre-traction \$ = standard × 0.5. "Standard" applies at BTI = 1.0. Founding partners pay standard × 0.75, locked 5 years.

Facilitator

PLAN	PRE-TRACTION \$	STANDARD \$	ON-SITE TAKE (FOUNDATION SHARE) IP / NON-IP	OFF-SITE TAKE
Monthly	\$49	\$99	25% / 50% → 30% / 50%	5% → 10%
Annual	\$499	\$999	22% / 45% → 35% / 55%	7% → 12%
2-Year	\$899	\$1,799	20% / 40% → 40% / 60%	10% → 15%

Note: Foundation share is **higher** when the facilitator presents their **own** (non-IP) content, because there's less foundation-IP value to compensate.

Vendor

PLAN	PRE-TRACTION \$	STANDARD \$	ON-SITE TAKE (FOUNDATION SHARE)	OFF-SITE TAKE
Monthly	\$25	\$49	15% → 18%	3% → 5%
Annual	\$249	\$499	18% → 22%	5% → 7%
2-Year	\$449	\$899	22% → 25%	7% → 10%

Community / Affiliate — Free entry

PLAN	PRE-TRACTION \$	STANDARD \$	THEIR REFERRAL SHARE	WHAT HIGHER TIERS ADD
Starter	FREE	FREE	8%	Basic referral link, basic analytics
Plus	\$9/mo	\$19/mo	10%	Custom UTM links, monthly digest, public profile
Pro	\$49/yr	\$99/yr	12%	Featured listing eligibility, top-of-directory rotation
2-Year Pro	\$79	\$159	12% locked	Founding eligibility, locks rate through traffic growth

Research — Free entry + Eminence Sharing Agreement

PLAN	PRE-TRACTION \$	STANDARD \$	WHAT IT INCLUDES
Standard	FREE	FREE	Submit research, public profile, chronological listing, Eminence Sharing terms apply

PLAN	PRE-TRACTION \$	STANDARD \$	WHAT IT INCLUDES
Featured (à la carte)	\$29/wk or \$99/mo	\$49/wk or \$179/mo	Homepage rotation, top of category, expanded mission alignment, video embed
Citation Pro	\$49/yr	\$99/yr	Citation analytics, DOI minting assistance, press-release co-rights

*On-site rev share: foundation gets **5%** on monetized research items. Off-site: **3%** on outbound-attributed sales of paid research.*

Founding Partner overlay (all classes)

- First **25 partners per type** (100 total) during the 2-month outreach window
- Locked at **Standard × 0.75** for **5 years**
- **Immune to BTI surge increases**; still benefits from BTI decreases (wins both ways)
- "Founding Partner" badge displayed publicly
- One-time eligibility, non-renewable

6 · Mission alignment check

CONCERN RAISED	HOW THIS ADDRESSES IT
"Don't charge people who help us"	Community + Research move to FREE entry tier
"Capture value where appropriate"	Vendors + Facilitators (revenue-generating) still subscribe; eminence captured from researchers
"Don't price-gouge on low traffic"	BTI multiplier $\times 0.5$ today; transparently published
"Surge when we outperform"	BTI $\times 1.15$ – 1.30 at scale
"Workers worthy of wages"	Founding partner discount = our recognition of early believers
"Not primarily a money-making org"	Foundation share scales with partner revenue — we eat only when they eat

7 · Final confirmations before implementation

Q1 BTI formula. Use 50K visitors / 2.5% conversion as the parity baselines, or adjust?

Q2 Free Community + Free Research entry — structural change from the existing \$29 / \$49 monthly subscriptions in v1.8.0 — confirmed?

Q3 Eminence Sharing Agreement — draft a v1 of the legal text as part of the v1.6.0 indemnification flow, or punt drafting to outside counsel and just wire the toggle?

Q4 Pre-traction multiplier — start at $\times 0.50$ immediately, or $\times 1.00$ (standard) and only reduce once BTI is measured live?

Q5 Founding partner cap — 25 per type / 100 total confirmed?

Q6 Transparency page at /governance/revenue-sharing — publish actual BTI value and current multiplier publicly, or admin-only?